

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	5 — The Rise of Empires
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Apex-tier traps: treating Prakrit/Brahmi as one thing or swapping which is language vs script; imagining Alexander held Indian land or beat Magadha; reading the emperor as a direct village-ruler rather than working through tributaries, satraps and officials; reversing the Kalinga-then-Dhamma sequence; confusing who wrote the Arthashastra with who wrote the Indica; scrambling the Nanda-Maurya-Bindusara-Ashoka order; and mistaking a single support of empire for the whole. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A scholar notes that the English word 'empire' carries inside it the Latin idea of imperium, while 'kingdom' simply names the realm of a king. Used carefully, this difference of roots is meant to highlight that the deepest distinction between the two is not size or riches but:

- (A) the kind of authority involved — supreme overlordship exercised over many lands and lesser rulers, rather than rule over one realm
- (B) the language in which each was officially named, Latin for one and a local tongue for the other
- (C) the fact that only an empire is permitted to keep a standing army of its own
- (D) the requirement that an empire always hold more gold in its treasury than any kingdom

2. Two realms, P and Q, are described. In P, a single ruler's commands stop at his own frontier and there are no lesser kings beneath him. In Q, several crowned kings keep their thrones but each must obey one paramount lord and send him tribute. A student labels P

the empire because it is 'more tightly unified under one will.' The flaw in this reasoning is that:

- (A) P is the empire, since an empire by definition allows no lesser kings to keep their thrones at all
- (B) tight rule by one will within a single frontier is exactly a kingdom; the empire is the structure that layers subordinate kings beneath a supreme overlord, which is Q
- (C) both P and Q are empires, because any realm with a single supreme ruler is imperial
- (D) neither is an empire, because an empire must be a republic that elects its ruler

3. An emperor faces a choice in a newly won, distant region. Option 1: leave the defeated local king on his throne in exchange for yearly tribute. Option 2: post a salaried governor who holds no realm of his own. He picks Option 1 here but Option 2 in a frontier zone. The single purpose served in BOTH choices, despite their difference, is best stated as:

- (A) removing any need for the emperor to maintain an army anywhere in the realm
- (B) deciding in advance which subordinate would become the next emperor
- (C) controlling distant land without the emperor having to govern every village in person, whether through a throne-keeping tributary or an appointed satrap
- (D) guaranteeing that the distant region would pay no taxes to the centre at all

4. The chapter lists six supports an empire must maintain. A planner argues that with a strong army and a full treasury he can simply seize whatever else he needs, so the other four supports are luxuries. Which single line best exposes why this 'army-plus-treasury is enough' view fails on the chapter's own logic?

- (A) an army and a treasury are forbidden to operate at the same time, so relying on both is impossible
- (B) the treasury can only be filled by the army's plunder, so the two are really one support, not two
- (C) force and funds can hold ground but cannot by themselves move orders across distance, knit trade under one system, or bind diverse peoples by a shared culture — tasks the other supports exist to do
- (D) art and learning are the single most important support, outranking the army and treasury together

5. Of the six supports, the chapter treats one as the base that pays for several others. A debater says, 'Then the army is the foundation, because the army wins the wealth.'

Reading the chapter's actual causal chain, the better correction is that:

- (A) the army is indeed the base, since without conquest there would be no provinces to tax
- (B) the common currency is the base, because coins are what soldiers and officials are ultimately made of

(C) support for art and learning is the base, since culture must exist before any economy can

(D) a thriving economy — trade and the taxes on it — is the base, because its wealth is what pays for the army, the officials and the communication networks in the first place

6. An emperor decrees one common currency and one set of weights and measures across his lands. A merchant in a far province asks why this matters to him personally. The chapter's reasoning gives an answer that links the merchant's gain to the state's gain.

Which statement captures BOTH together?

(A) the merchant is relieved of all taxes, and the state gains because it no longer needs a treasury

(B) the merchant can trade with distant regions on shared terms, and that same shared system lets the state measure and tax the trade uniformly — so commerce and revenue both grow

(C) the merchant gains a personal monopoly, and the state gains because trade is restricted to him alone

(D) the merchant is freed from the army's protection, and the state gains by disbanding its soldiers

7. An empire grows lax, and over time its two wealthiest provinces end up minting unlike coins and using mismatched weights and measures. Walking through the chapter's logic, what is the most probable knock-on effect for the empire?

(A) each province funds its own troops, so the imperial army automatically becomes stronger overall

(B) the emperor can now govern each province directly, dispensing with officials in both

(C) cross-province trade and uniform taxation both become harder, so revenue falls and the economic unity that funds the empire weakens

(D) both provinces immediately raise more food and mine more iron because of the new coins

8. A king is advised either to leave the weavers' shreni to fix its own prices, elect its own head and settle its own disputes, or to station soldiers to run it day to day. The chapter favours the first. Which option best states the king's real motive AND the specific risk the second course would carry?

(A) his motive is that the law forbids any king from touching trade; policing would merely break that law with no further effect

(B) his motive is that guilds pay no taxes whatever; policing would be pointless since there is nothing to gain from them

(C) his motive is that self-governing guilds keep production and trade orderly, feeding his tax revenue; heavy policing would disrupt that smooth commerce and so cut the very revenue he depends on

(D) his motive is that he has no power at all over guilds; policing would fail because guilds formally outrank the king

9. A classmate dismisses the Uttarapatha and the Dakshinapatha as 'just roads for soldiers to march on.' Drawing on the chapter, what fuller account shows these arteries serving several supports of empire at once?

(A) the empire's permanent borders, since these routes fixed the exact edge of every Indian empire

(B) ocean commerce, since both were sea lanes giving India command of maritime trade

(C) edict-carrying alone, since the routes existed only so Ashoka could send his inscriptions outward

(D) taxable long-distance trade, swift communication of news and orders, and military reach — several supports reinforced together, not military movement alone

10. Iron from the hills near Magadha is said to have helped it along two different supports of empire at the same time. Which option names both effects AND correctly matches each to the support it strengthened?

(A) iron coins served as the empire's common currency, while iron ships built a navy for ocean trade

(B) iron ploughs raised food output, strengthening the economy and feeding a larger population, while iron weapons armed a strong military

(C) iron sold abroad earned gold for the treasury, while iron paid as tribute won over rival kings

(D) iron pillars carried Ashoka's edicts, while iron temples deepened the people's loyalty

11. Among the sixteen mahajanapadas, only Magadha rose to imperial greatness. A teacher warns against 'just listing' its advantages and asks instead WHY they mattered. The best single explanation is that:

(A) great seaports and a strong navy let Magadha command ocean trade beyond the reach of inland rivals

(B) gold mines and control of the distant Silk Road made it suddenly richer than every rival

(C) snowy mountains and a protective cold desert sheltered it so completely that it never needed an army

(D) fertile soil fed a large population, iron equipped and armed it, elephant forests gave war-power, and the rivers cheaply moved goods and troops, so each advantage reinforced the others into combined strength

12. To argue that Mahapadma Nanda was already reaching beyond ordinary kingship toward something imperial, a historian needs the single strongest piece of supporting evidence. Which of his actions best serves that argument?

- (A) he composed the Arthashastra and appointed dhamma-mahamatras to guide his people
- (B) he carved moral edicts on rock and stone pillars across his lands
- (C) he defeated Alexander's army on the banks of the Indus and turned him back
- (D) he welded many separate kingdoms under one authority while issuing coins and maintaining a vast army — the marks of an empire taking shape

13. The last Nanda king, though immensely wealthy, lost his subjects' loyalty, and that loss is precisely what gave his challenger an opening. Which option correctly links the CAUSE of the lost loyalty to its CONSEQUENCE for the dynasty?

- (A) he gave the whole treasury away to the poor, leaving the state too weak to resist, which is why Chandragupta won
- (B) he refused to mint any coins, so trade stopped and the people, ruined, welcomed a Greek satrap instead
- (C) he handed his throne voluntarily to Alexander, and the resentment of foreign rule destroyed the dynasty
- (D) he oppressed and over-taxed his people, so their support collapsed, and that collapse opened the way for Chandragupta to overthrow him

14. A museum places a Nanda exhibit and a Maurya exhibit side by side and asks visitors to write one caption that fits BOTH their order in time and how their roles relate. Which caption is accurate?

- (A) the Nandas first welded Magadha's lands into one large power, and the Mauryas then displaced them and pushed the empire across most of the subcontinent
- (B) the Mauryas founded the first large state in Magadha and the Nandas later overthrew them and shrank it
- (C) the Nandas and the Mauryas ruled side by side as bitter rivals at exactly the same time
- (D) the Nandas carved edicts across the land while the Mauryas left no inscriptions of any kind

15. Around 326 BCE Alexander reached the northwest of India, and shortly after defeating Porus he turned homeward. Which option names BOTH the great power he had already conquered before reaching India AND the immediate reason he then retreated?

- (A) he had already conquered the Nanda Empire, and he turned back because Chandragupta defeated him in battle
- (B) he had already conquered the Maurya empire, and he turned back when the Nandas paid him tribute to leave

(C) he had already conquered the Roman Empire, and he turned back after exhausting his weapons and supplies

(D) he had already conquered the Persian (Achaemenid) Empire, and he turned back because his weary soldiers refused to march further east

16. A quiz card reads: 'I held a kingdom in the northwest near the Indus, and a foreign invader defeated me in battle, yet my name is remembered for the encounter.' Which figure does the card describe?

(A) he was the Macedonian general Alexander left behind as a satrap to govern Indian lands

(B) he was the Greek envoy who later wrote an outsider's account of the Mauryan court

(C) he was the northwestern king of the Pauravas whom Alexander defeated in battle near the Indus

(D) he was the Magadhan ruler who founded the Nanda dynasty

17. The chapter says Alexander's lasting effect on India was mostly indirect. A student counters, 'But he won the battle against Porus, so his effect must have been direct.' The best resolution is that:

(A) his effect was direct, since he governed northern India himself for about fifty years

(B) winning a battle is not the same as holding land; Alexander kept no Indian territory for long, leaving weak governors and new contacts, so his influence worked through openings rather than direct rule

(C) his effect was direct, since he personally founded the Maurya dynasty that ruled afterward

(D) his effect was direct, since he carved edicts in Greek across India to teach his laws

18. The chapter says conditions left after Alexander's departure and death helped Chandragupta expand rapidly in the northwest. Which condition helped him most there, AND why did it help?

(A) the weak Greek satraps Alexander left behind lost their grip after his death, so Chandragupta could defeat or absorb them

(B) a strong, united Greek army still guarded the northwest, which he won over wholesale to his side

(C) a peace treaty Ashoka had already signed for the region removed all resistance in advance

(D) the lifelong loyalty of the Nanda soldiers, who had served Chandragupta since his birth

19. A timeline labels the year about 321 BCE as the birth of the Maurya empire. Asked to explain in one line how its founder pulled this off, the chapter would point chiefly to which pairing?

(A) being crowned emperor of all India by Alexander before the Greek king departed

(B) overthrowing the unpopular Nandas, guided by the strategy and counsel of Kautilya

- (C) inheriting the throne peacefully from his grandson Ashoka
- (D) marrying into the Persian royal house and borrowing its armies

20. A library catalogue must list, under one strategist's entry, his alternative names and the kind of book he wrote — taking care not to file the Greek envoy's book under his name. Which entry is correct for Chandragupta's mentor?

- (A) he was also called Chanakya or Vishnugupta, and his Arthashastra is a treatise on the science of governance and economics, distinct from Megasthenes' Indica
- (B) he was also called Megasthenes, and his Indica is the treatise on governance and economics
- (C) he was also called Panini, and his Arthashastra is a collection of Ashoka's moral edicts
- (D) he was also called Porus, and his Arthashastra is a book of court poetry praising the emperor

21. Kautilya likens the state to a body of seven limbs, the saptanga. A student lists 'king, queen, priests, merchants, farmers, soldiers and slaves' and explains they must cooperate 'because seven was a lucky number.' Both the list and the reason are wrong. The correct version is:

- (A) land, sea, forests, mines, rivers, hills and cities — because a state is simply the sum of its geography
- (B) the king, the ministers, the territory and people, the fort, the treasury, the army and the allies — and they must work together because if any one limb is weak the whole body, the state, suffers
- (C) army, navy, cavalry, forts, coins, roads and temples — because military power is the only thing that holds a state together
- (D) king, queen, priests, merchants, farmers, soldiers and slaves — but they cooperate because tradition demanded it, not luck

22. Pointing out that the treasury was what actually paid the soldiers, a student insists Kautilya was wrong to count the treasury and the army as two different limbs of the saptanga. How is this objection best answered?

- (A) the separation is indeed a mistake, since the treasury and the army are really one limb
- (B) they are kept distinct because they perform different functions — one funds the state's needs and the other defends and enforces its authority — even though the treasury pays for the army
- (C) they are separate because the army was always paid in grain, never from the treasury
- (D) they are separate because the treasury and the army were never in use at the same time

23. Three name-cards — Bindusara, Megasthenes, Kautilya — must each be pinned to the right role-card: 'son of the founder and father of Ashoka', 'Greek envoy to the court', and 'mentor who wrote the Arthashastra'. Which pinning is correct?

- (A) Bindusara was the Greek envoy; Megasthenes was the mentor-author; Kautilya was Ashoka's father
- (B) Bindusara was Chandragupta's son and Ashoka's father; Megasthenes was the Greek envoy to the Mauryan court; Kautilya was the mentor who wrote the Arthashastra
- (C) Bindusara was the mentor-author; Megasthenes was Ashoka's father; Kautilya was the Greek envoy
- (D) Bindusara was the founder of the empire; Megasthenes was Chandragupta's son; Kautilya was the last Nanda king

24. Megasthenes and Kautilya are both tied to the Mauryan court, yet what one wrote differs sharply in kind from what the other wrote. A historian wants the source that best reveals how the Mauryan state was meant to be run from the inside, and separately the one that gives a foreign visitor's snapshot. Which statement matches each correctly?

- (A) Megasthenes' Arthashastra is the insider's manual, while Kautilya's Indica is the outsider's account
- (B) both wrote religious scriptures, so neither offers either an insider manual or an outsider snapshot
- (C) Kautilya's Arthashastra is the insider's manual of statecraft revealing how the state was meant to run, while Megasthenes' Indica is the outsider's eyewitness account of Mauryan India
- (D) Kautilya wrote court poetry praising the emperor, while Megasthenes carved the rock edicts

25. Bindusara is easy to overlook between two more famous Mauryas. Placing the dynasty in order — Chandragupta, Bindusara, Ashoka — which statement about Bindusara is exactly right?

- (A) he was the son of Chandragupta and the father of Ashoka, ruling between the founder and the Dhamma emperor
- (B) he was the mentor of Chandragupta who wrote the Arthashastra
- (C) he was the Greek envoy who described the Mauryan court in the Indica
- (D) he was the founder of the dynasty who overthrew the unpopular Nandas

26. Faced with provinces too far to oversee in person, the Mauryan state built one main structure and then added a second layer on top of it. Which option names the main structure AND explains what the network of spies was for?

- (A) the provinces were abolished so each village ruled itself, and the spies replaced the need for an army
- (B) each region was handed to the guilds to govern, and the spies took the place of the common currency
- (C) the realm was divided into provinces under governors and officials reporting to the centre, and spies let the centre learn what was happening far off and check on those very officials
- (D) the emperor toured every village in person each year, and the spies served instead of provincial governors

27. An advisor proposes funding the Mauryan state by occasional war-plunder and gifts from allies instead of regular taxes. Using the chapter, why would the king reject this and rely on steady taxation?

- (A) because taxation was mainly the emperor's tool for punishing provinces that had been disloyal
- (B) because the taxes existed only to enrich the guilds of the great cities
- (C) because taxation replaced the need for any trade or economy at all
- (D) because regular, dependable tax revenue is what funded the army, the officials and the empire's works over the long term, in a way windfalls could not

28. An organisation chart of Mauryan officials has slots for cavalry commanders, tribute collectors, stone-carvers and dhamma-mahamatras. Into which distinctive duty does the last group fit, unlike the others?

- (A) to command the cavalry guarding the empire's frontiers, much like any military officer
- (B) their task was to spread and oversee the practice of Dhamma, Ashoka's code of moral conduct, among the people — a moral-guidance role, unlike collecting revenue or commanding troops
- (C) to gather the yearly tribute from the empire's subordinate kings, like a senior tax official
- (D) to cut the Brahmi letters of the edicts into the rock faces, as skilled stone-carvers

29. In a debate, one side claims that because Mauryan governors handled the provinces, the empire could have done away with both its army and its treasury. What is the strongest rebuttal from the chapter?

- (A) because the officials existed mainly to compose poetry in praise of the emperor
- (B) because the officials abolished taxes throughout the empire, leaving no treasury to maintain

(C) because each official commanded his own private army, so no imperial army was needed

(D) officials extended the centre's authority into far provinces, complementing the army and treasury rather than replacing them, because an empire still needed force to enforce and funds to operate

30. A blank map of the subcontinent is to be shaded for Ashoka's empire at its height. Which single instruction correctly tells the student one area to leave blank AND one area to shade?

(A) it did not include the far south of the peninsula, but it did include the northwest reaching toward parts of Afghanistan

(B) it did not include the Ganga plains around Pataliputra, but it did include the far south

(C) it did not include the northwest near Afghanistan, but it did include only the eastern lands

(D) it did not include the eastern lands toward modern Bangladesh, and it also left out the Ganga plains

31. An essay opens, 'Ashoka launched the Kalinga campaign as a mission to spread Buddhism across the east.' A teacher marks the opening wrong. Which correction names the real error AND puts the events back in their true order?

(A) the error is the place: Ashoka never fought a war at Kalinga, so the question of motive does not arise

(B) the order is reversed: Ashoka attacked Kalinga to expand his empire, and it was the horror of the bloodshed afterwards that turned him toward Dhamma

(C) the error is the religion: Kalinga had already become Buddhist, so there was nothing left to spread

(D) the error is the rule: Buddhism forbade any king from ever waging war, so Ashoka could not have fought

32. A sceptic says Ashoka's remorse over Kalinga was probably invented later by admirers. Which piece of evidence most directly answers the sceptic by showing the regret in a first-person source from Ashoka's own time?

(A) because Megasthenes described Ashoka's grief in detail in the Indica

(B) because Ashoka himself recorded his remorse over the slaughter in his own edicts, leaving us his sorrow in his own words for his own people to read

(C) because Kautilya wrote of Ashoka's remorse in the Arthashastra

(D) because a much later king built a temple specifically to commemorate Ashoka's sorrow

33. Imagine a 'what-if' history in which the Kalinga slaughter left Ashoka unmoved and hungry for more conquest. Reasoning from the chapter, what would most plausibly be different about his reign?

- (A) the Maurya empire would have collapsed that very same year
- (B) the Brahmi script would never have been deciphered by later scholars
- (C) he might have waged further aggressive wars, and the Dhamma edicts we read today would never have been composed
- (D) Chandragupta, his grandfather, would somehow have lost his throne

34. Ashoka's idea of Dhamma is sometimes mistaken for an entirely new religion. Reading the chapter carefully, Dhamma is best understood as:

- (A) a brand-new religion meant to replace Buddhism throughout the empire
- (B) a special yearly tax demanded from the tributary kings
- (C) a broad code of moral and ethical conduct — honesty, non-violence, tolerance and the truthful doing of one's duties — addressed to all his subjects
- (D) the science of warfare and battlefield strategy taught to his officers

35. A modern PR student is asked why Ashoka earns the label 'great communicator' and why his chosen method fit an empire of scattered, far-apart peoples. Which answer is right on both counts?

- (A) he engraved edicts on rocks and stone pillars across the empire — a durable, public medium that could stand in many far-flung places at once and last for centuries
- (B) he sent soldiers to recite his words aloud in every village, so each person heard them once
- (C) he printed books for every household, so the message reached homes directly
- (D) he built one great central temple, so that all his subjects could gather in it to hear the message

36. Reading that Ashoka's edicts are 'in Prakrit, written in Brahmi,' a classmate concludes the two words must mean the same thing. To untangle the confusion, the precise point to make is that:

- (A) Brahmi is the spoken language and Prakrit is the script used to write it down
- (B) Prakrit is a language that people spoke, while Brahmi is a script — a way of writing it down — so the two belong to different categories
- (C) both are scripts, and only the Greeks ever used either of them
- (D) both are languages, and neither of them is a script at all

37. Two choices Ashoka made about his edicts — the language and the surface — each served the goal of reaching ordinary people lastingly. Which option explains BOTH choices correctly?

- (A) he used Prakrit because Sanskrit had not yet been invented, and he carved on stone because it was simply the cheapest material
- (B) he used Prakrit because it was a secret tongue kept from commoners, and he carved on stone because Brahmi could only be written on stone

(C) he used everyday Prakrit so ordinary people could understand the message directly, and he carved on stone because stone is permanent and public, surviving weather and centuries

(D) he used Prakrit because it was the only language that could be carved, and he carved on stone because paper and cloth did not exist anywhere

38. Setting aside the edicts, a teacher asks what long-term mark Brahmi left on writing in India and what kind of speech Prakrit was. Which answer gets both right?

(A) Brahmi is identical to the modern Roman alphabet, and Prakrit was a refined court language few could speak

(B) Brahmi is the ancestor from which most of today's Indian scripts descend, and Prakrit was the everyday spoken language of the common people of the time

(C) Brahmi has never been deciphered by scholars, and Prakrit was a secret code of the priests

(D) Brahmi was a spoken language used only in the Mauryan court, and Prakrit was the script used to record it

39. A school project must connect three things: India's national emblem, the Mauryan pillar it once topped, and the wheel at the centre of the national flag. Which set of links is entirely correct?

(A) the Great Stupa at Sanchi became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel is the wheel of a Mauryan war chariot

(B) the rock-cut elephant at Dhauli became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel symbolises the empire's trade routes

(C) the Lion Capital that crowned Ashoka's pillar at Sarnath became the national emblem, and the dharmachakra on the flag, the wheel of dharma, is drawn from the same Mauryan art

(D) the terracotta dancing figure became the national emblem, and the flag's wheel is the sun worshipped by the Mauryan kings

40. A guide at the site explains what the 'capital' in 'Lion Capital of Sarnath' actually refers to, and why Ashoka raised the pillar at Sarnath of all places. Which explanation is correct on both points?

(A) the capital is the empire's capital city, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where Ashoka was crowned emperor

(B) the capital is the empire's treasury, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where the Kalinga war was fought

(C) the capital is the main edict carved on the pillar, and Sarnath was chosen because Chandragupta defeated the Nandas there

(D) the capital is the carved top, or crowning head, of the stone column, and Sarnath was chosen because it was where the Buddha gave his first teaching

41. Two dates sit on a timeline: Ashoka's death in 232 BCE and the empire's end around 185 BCE. A student is asked what the size of that interval reveals and how it supports the chapter's broader theme. Which reading is right?

- (A) the empire fell within about half a century of Ashoka's death, showing how quickly even a great empire can unravel once its strongest ruler is gone
- (B) the empire fell roughly two centuries after his death, showing how stable empires usually were
- (C) the empire fell within a single year of his death, proving that an empire dies the moment its emperor does
- (D) the empire fell more than three hundred years after his death, showing it long outlived its greatest king

42. An exam asks students to fold two of the chapter's words about empire — 'fragile' and 'paradox' — into one sentence that explains both at once. Which sentence does this correctly?

- (A) an empire can bring unity and prosperity yet rests on force and tribute, so when the centre weakens distant regions break away and even the greatest fall
- (B) an empire is at once very small and very large, and it is fragile because it never keeps an army to defend itself
- (C) an empire has an emperor but no kings beneath him, and it is fragile because it refuses to collect any tribute
- (D) an empire collects tribute but spends nothing on an army, and it is fragile because it has too much wealth to defend

43. A governor of a far province is weighing whether to risk a revolt. By the chapter's reasoning about when breakaways happen, under which combination of circumstances is his temptation to rebel GREATEST?

- (A) a succession of strong emperors, each keeping the provinces firmly in check
- (B) lower tribute demands during a long stretch of peace and prosperity
- (C) a weak emperor following a strong one, combined with heavier tribute demands — giving the province both the opportunity and the grievance to rebel
- (D) the building of better roads that tie the province more closely to the capital

44. An archaeologist plots the find-spots of dozens of Ashokan edicts on a map and notices they cluster across a wide territory. Of the following, what is this distribution of find-spots MOST reliable for inferring, and why not the rest?

- (A) it tells us the exact year Alexander was born, because edicts always record royal birthdays
- (B) it tells us the day-to-day price of iron in Magadha's markets, because edicts list market prices

(C) it tells us the precise number of guilds in each Mauryan city, because edicts register every guild

(D) it traces roughly how far Ashoka's empire and influence reached, because the edicts were placed across the lands he controlled

45. A researcher wants, first, the source that best reveals Ashoka's own mind and, second, the one that best gives a foreign visitor's impression of Mauryan India. Which assignment of the Indica and the rock edicts to these two needs is correct?

(A) the Indica, written by Ashoka himself, best reveals his thinking, while the edicts, written by a foreigner, give the outsider's snapshot

(B) both sources are Ashoka's own compositions, so neither offers any outside view at all

(C) both sources are foreign reports, so neither tells us anything directly from Ashoka

(D) the edicts, being Ashoka's own words inscribed for his people, best reveal his thinking, while the Indica, an outsider's account, best gives a foreign observer's snapshot of Mauryan India

46. Four event-cards are shuffled — Chandragupta founds the Maurya empire; Mahapadma Nanda founds the Nanda dynasty; Ashoka fights the Kalinga war; Alexander reaches the northwest of India — labelled (i), (ii), (iii), (iv) in that listing. Which arrangement puts them earliest to latest?

(A) (iv), (ii), (i), (iii)

(B) (ii), (i), (iv), (iii)

(C) (ii), (iv), (i), (iii)

(D) (i), (ii), (iv), (iii)

47. Staying within the Maurya dynasty's own span, a student must order these four moments earliest to latest: (i) Chandragupta founds the empire, (ii) Bindusara rules, (iii) Ashoka fights the Kalinga war, (iv) the empire ends around 185 BCE. Which order is right?

(A) (ii), (i), (iii), (iv)

(B) (i), (iii), (ii), (iv)

(C) (i), (ii), (iv), (iii)

(D) (i), (ii), (iii), (iv)

48. A new empire arises with a strong army, capable officials and excellent roads, but it lets each region keep its own different coins and measures. Which support is it failing to maintain, and what is the most likely result?

(A) it is failing to maintain a common currency, weights and measures, so cross-region trade and uniform taxation both become harder, weakening its economy

(B) it is failing to maintain an army, so its frontiers will be overrun within the year

(C) it is failing to maintain communication networks, so no orders can reach the provinces

(D) it is failing to maintain support for art and learning, so it will lose all its officials

49. A student mixes up the Persian and the Maurya empires when talking about Alexander. Sorting out the timeline, which statement correctly relates each of these two empires to him?

- (A) Alexander had conquered the Persian Empire before reaching India, whereas the Maurya empire did not yet exist and was founded only a few years after he left
- (B) Alexander conquered both the Persian and the Maurya empires before turning home
- (C) Alexander conquered the Maurya empire but left the Persian Empire untouched
- (D) both the Persian and the Maurya empires defeated Alexander and drove him out of Asia

50. A textbook groups tributaries, satraps and a body of officials together under a single heading. What is the unifying idea that justifies treating these three as one connected solution rather than three separate facts?

- (A) because all three were means of choosing the next emperor when the throne fell vacant
- (B) because all three existed mainly to compose praise-poetry for the emperor
- (C) because all three were ways of avoiding the need to collect any tribute or taxes
- (D) because all three are ways of extending the emperor's authority over lands too distant for him to govern in person

51. Two officials are introduced: one still wears his own crown but sends yearly tribute, the other is paid by the overlord and rules a province he does not own. Which statement labels each correctly as a tributary or a satrap?

- (A) a tributary keeps his own throne while paying tribute, whereas a satrap is an appointed governor who owns no kingdom of his own
- (B) a tributary is an appointed official with no realm, while a satrap is a king who keeps his own throne
- (C) a tributary always rules a far larger territory than the overlord himself, unlike a satrap
- (D) a tributary is by rule always Greek, while a satrap is by rule always Indian

52. An archaeologist describes a Mauryan city as neatly laid out, well stocked with grain and clearly prosperous. Read as evidence, these features most directly showcase which two supports of empire working hand in hand?

- (A) the absence of any army and the absence of a common currency
- (B) a reliance on tribute alone with no economy behind it
- (C) a strong administration and control over resources — the one planning the city, the other securing its food and prosperity
- (D) a refusal to support art and learning combined with isolation from trade

53. A general boasts that his soldiers alone could hold the whole empire together with no other support behind them. Drawing on the chapter, what is the chief flaw in the general's boast?

- (A) because an army is hugely expensive, so without a thriving economy and steady tax revenue it cannot be paid or maintained
- (B) because an army is by rule forbidden from entering the empire's distant provinces
- (C) because soldiers were unpaid volunteers, so the cost of an army was never a concern
- (D) because the frontiers were defended entirely by tributary kings, so the emperor kept no army at all

54. Picture a different ending in which Dhana Nanda governed fairly and his subjects stayed loyal to him. Reasoning from why he actually lost power, what would most likely have followed in this version?

- (A) Ashoka would never have been born into the world
- (B) the Nanda dynasty might have lasted longer and better resisted Chandragupta's challenge, since it was lost loyalty that opened the way for him
- (C) Alexander would then have conquered the whole of India
- (D) Kautilya would have written two separate copies of the Arthashastra

55. A rising power ticks off five things — army, officials, currency, roads — but deliberately spends nothing on art and learning. Of the chapter's six supports, which gap will hurt it most, and what makes that harm different from what the other supports would have prevented?

- (A) it will be unable to collect any tribute, because tribute depends on patronage of the arts
- (B) it will lack the shared culture that binds diverse peoples, a cohesion that force and administration by themselves cannot supply
- (C) it will lose every soldier within a year, because armies cannot exist without poets and scholars
- (D) it will be unable to build even a single fort, because forts require artists to design them

56. An emperor already has a powerful army but is told he still cannot do without good roads and fast messengers. Why is a communication network indispensable in a way the army alone cannot make up for?

- (A) because it carried orders, troops and news swiftly across great distances, so the centre could actually direct affairs in regions the emperor never saw
- (B) because it replaced the need for any army, since fast messages could defend the frontier by themselves
- (C) because it served chiefly to collect tribute, taking over the work of the officials
- (D) because it let the emperor abolish the common currency he no longer needed

57. Two facts are given: a merchants' shreni set its own fair prices, chose its own head and settled its own disputes; and wise kings generally let such guilds run themselves. Which single conclusion follows when these two facts are put together?

- (A) the guilds were really run day to day by the king's own soldiers, who only seemed to let them self-govern
- (B) the guilds existed purely to collect tribute on the king's behalf, which is why he tolerated them
- (C) self-governing guilds kept craft and trade orderly and prosperous, and that prosperity fed the king's tax revenue, so it served his interest to leave them alone
- (D) the guilds were tiny family workshops with no shared rules, so there was nothing for the king to control

58. If the whole chapter had to be compressed into one closing maxim about empires, which statement comes closest to its deepest lesson?

- (A) once founded, an empire endures forever, unchanged by the strength or weakness of its rulers
- (B) an empire needs only a single strong emperor and nothing else to last
- (C) tribute by itself, with neither army nor administration, is enough to rule an empire
- (D) building an empire is hard but holding one together is harder still, so even the greatest empires eventually decline

59. A teacher gives this scenario: an emperor stops patronising art and learning, lets each province coin its own money, and personally tries to inspect every village himself, abandoning his officials. Using the chapter's framework, which combined weakness would most directly follow?

- (A) the empire loses the shared culture that binds diverse peoples and the unified trade-and-tax system, while the centre's reach into distant regions collapses because no officials carry its authority
- (B) the empire grows stronger, since cutting art spending and local coinage frees money for the army and lets the emperor rule more closely
- (C) nothing changes, because art, currency and officials are decorative extras rather than real supports of empire
- (D) the empire's army instantly disbands and its frontiers vanish, since these three choices destroy the military first of all

60. A scholar arranges the chapter's people by the role each played in building or running an empire and finds one figure mismatched. Which pairing of figure-to-role is INCORRECT?

- (A) Chandragupta — the conqueror who founded the empire by displacing the Nandas
- (B) Kautilya — the mentor and theorist who set down the science of governance
- (C) Ashoka — the ruler who, after a devastating war, governed by a moral code and edicts
- (D) Megasthenes — the architect of Mauryan statecraft who wrote the manual the empire was governed by

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 5: The Rise of Empires — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	D	21	B	31	B	41	A	51	A
2	B	12	D	22	B	32	B	42	A	52	C
3	C	13	D	23	B	33	C	43	C	53	A
4	C	14	A	24	C	34	C	44	D	54	B
5	D	15	D	25	A	35	A	45	D	55	B
6	B	16	C	26	C	36	B	46	C	56	A
7	C	17	B	27	D	37	C	47	D	57	C
8	C	18	A	28	B	38	B	48	A	58	D
9	D	19	B	29	D	39	C	49	A	59	A
10	B	20	A	30	A	40	D	50	D	60	D

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) Imperium points to a type of power — supreme command over many lands and the rulers within them — which is exactly the layered overlordship that marks an empire off from a single kingdom; that is the intended point. The naming-in-Latin option mistakes the etymology lesson for a claim about official titles, which the chapter never makes. The standing-army option is false because ordinary kingdoms also kept armies; what differs is whom the supreme power reaches over. The treasury option reduces the contrast to wealth, the very surface feature the question says is NOT the deepest distinction.

2. (B) An empire is defined by layered sovereignty — subordinate kings remaining on their thrones under one overlord — so Q, not P, is the empire; the student has mistaken internal tightness for the imperial structure. The option calling P the empire because empires allow no lesser kings inverts the definition: tributary kings keeping their thrones are central to how empires work. Calling both empires ignores that P has no subordinate kings at all. The republic option is simply outside the chapter, which describes empires as ruled by emperors, not elected.

3. (C) Both a tributary king and a satrap are devices for ruling far-off lands indirectly, sparing the emperor from administering every village himself — that shared purpose is what the question asks for. The no-army option is false; tributaries and satraps coexisted with armies and did not abolish the need for force. The succession option imports a rule about choosing the next emperor that the chapter never attaches to these arrangements. The no-taxes option contradicts the very point of tribute, which is revenue flowing to the centre.

4. (C) The chapter frames the six supports as solving distinct problems — communication for distance, currency for unified trade and tax, art and learning for cultural cohesion — none of which raw force or stored wealth performs, so the army-plus-treasury view leaves real gaps; that is the correct refutation. The 'forbidden to operate together' option invents a non-existent rule. Collapsing treasury into army misreads the chapter, which treats a thriving economy and trade, not just plunder, as the wealth source. Ranking art and learning above all is a different (and unsupported) claim; the chapter presents the supports as interlocking, not hierarchical in that way.

5. (D) The chapter explicitly makes a thriving economy the support on which the army, officials and roads rest, because the wealth from trade and taxation funds them; that reverses the debater's claim that the army comes first. The army-as-base option confuses winning land with sustaining the realm: an unfunded army cannot be paid or kept. The currency-as-base option mistakes a tool for measuring and moving wealth for the source of wealth itself. The art-and-learning option inverts the dependency the chapter draws — culture is supported by the economy's surplus, not the other way round.

6. (B) A single currency and standard measures let distant regions trade smoothly and let the state tax that trade under one system — the merchant's easier commerce and the state's reliable revenue are two sides of the same coin, which is the linked answer required. The tax-relief option is wrong because uniform measures make taxing easier, not abolished. The monopoly option contradicts the point: shared standards open trade widely rather than restricting it to one person. The disbanding-the-army option is unrelated and false, since currency reform has nothing to do with ending military protection.

7. (C) Divergent coins and measures raise the friction of trade between the provinces and make the state's tax-gathering uneven, so revenue and the economic cohesion that the empire runs on both decline — the chain the chapter implies. The stronger-army option reverses cause and effect; weaker shared revenue does not strengthen the army. The govern-directly option is a non sequitur, since currency confusion does nothing to let an emperor personally rule far provinces. The more-food-and-iron option confuses monetary standards with agriculture and mining, which different coins would not boost.

8. (C) Self-running guilds kept craft and trade flowing, and that prosperity fed the king's treasury, so disrupting them with daily policing would damage the commerce that funded him — the motive and the risk the question wants. The legal-ban option invents a law

forbidding kings from touching trade, which the chapter never states. The no-taxes option misreads the relationship: the king benefits precisely because guild prosperity is taxable. The no-power option overstates the case; the king chooses to leave guilds alone for sound reasons, not because they outrank him.

9. (D) These overland arteries carried goods, news and troops, so controlling them brought taxable trade, fast communication and military reach together — the multi-support advantage the chapter stresses, which is more than just marching roads. The borders option is wrong: trade routes are not the same as fixed frontiers. The sea-lanes option misidentifies them; Uttarapatha and Dakshinapatha are overland routes, not ocean routes. The edicts-only option absurdly narrows their purpose to one ruler's inscriptions, ignoring their economic and military value.

10. (B) Iron ploughs lifted agricultural output (the economy) and iron weapons equipped the army (the military), so one resource advanced two distinct supports — the dual effect the chapter describes. The coins-and-ships option invents iron coinage and a Magadhan navy that the chapter does not describe. The sell-abroad-and-tribute option recasts iron as an export and a gift to rivals, which is not the chapter's account of how iron helped Magadha. The pillars-and-temples option borrows Ashokan edict-imagery and applies it wrongly to Magadha's early iron advantage.

11. (D) Magadha's advantages mattered because they reinforced one another — food sustaining people, iron arming and equipping them, elephants adding war-power, rivers moving everything cheaply — which is the interlocking logic the chapter draws, not a flat list. The seaports option is false; Magadha's strength was inland and river-based, not naval. The gold-and-Silk-Road option imports wealth sources the chapter does not credit to Magadha. The mountains-and-desert option not only misdescribes Magadha's geography but absurdly claims it needed no army, contradicting the chapter's stress on military strength.

12. (D) Unifying many kingdoms, issuing coins and keeping a huge army are exactly the imperial features the chapter credits to Mahapadma Nanda, refuting the 'ordinary king' claim. The Arthashastra-and-mahamatras option mixes Kautilya's work and an Ashokan office into the Nanda's reign, neither of which belongs to him. The edicts option transplants Ashoka's signature practice onto the Nandas. The Alexander option is chronologically and factually wrong: it was Chandragupta's era, and the Nandas did not defeat Alexander.

13. (D) Dhana Nanda's heavy taxation and oppression drained loyalty, and that very loss of support let Chandragupta overthrow him — the correct cause-and-consequence pairing. The giving-away-the-treasury option contradicts the chapter, which stresses his riches and oppression, not generosity. The no-coins option invents a trade collapse and a welcomed Greek satrap that the chapter does not describe. The handed-throne-to-Alexander option is plainly false; the Nandas neither surrendered to Alexander nor did he reach Magadha.

14. (A) The Nandas came first and unified Magadha; the Mauryas then replaced them and expanded far further — the correct order and division of roles. Reversing them, so the Mauryas came first and the Nandas overthrew them, scrambles the sequence. The 'side by side as rivals' option denies that one succeeded the other, which the chapter makes clear. The edicts option is the reverse of the truth: it was Ashoka the Maurya who is famous for edicts, not the Nandas.

15. (D) Alexander overran the Persian Empire on his way to India, and his exhausted troops' refusal to advance is the immediate cause the chapter gives for his retreat — both correct. The Nanda option is doubly wrong: he did not conquer the Nandas, and Chandragupta did not defeat him. The Maurya option is impossible, since the Maurya empire was founded only after Alexander left. The Roman option is anachronistic and false; Alexander never conquered Rome, which was not yet such a power.

16. (C) Porus was the Indian king of the Pauravas defeated by Alexander near the Indus — the chapter's clear description. The Macedonian-general option confuses Porus with a Greek satrap. The Greek-envoy option confuses him with Megasthenes, author of the Indica. The Nanda-founder option confuses him with Mahapadma Nanda; Porus had no part in founding the Nanda dynasty.

17. (B) A battlefield victory did not translate into lasting Indian rule; Alexander left weak satraps and opened contacts, so his real influence was indirect — the chapter's point, which answers the student's objection. The fifty-years option invents a long direct rule that never happened. The founded-the-Maurya-dynasty option is false; Chandragupta founded it. The Greek-edicts option fabricates a practice; the famous edicts were Ashoka's, in Prakrit and Brahmi, not Alexander's in Greek.

18. (A) Alexander's departure and death left weak Greek satraps whose hold crumbled, giving Chandragupta openings to defeat or absorb them in the northwest — the chapter's explanation. A 'strong, united Greek army' is the opposite of the weakness that actually helped him. The Ashoka-treaty option is anachronistic; Ashoka ruled generations later. The Nanda-loyalty option is false: Chandragupta overthrew the Nandas, so their soldiers were not his lifelong loyalists.

19. (B) Chandragupta rose by overthrowing the unpopular Nandas with Kautilya's guidance — the chapter's stated combination. The Alexander-crowning option is false; Alexander did not appoint him. The 'inherited from his grandson Ashoka' option reverses the generations, since Ashoka was Chandragupta's grandson, not the reverse. The Persian-marriage option invents an alliance the chapter does not describe.

20. (A) Kautilya was also known as Chanakya or Vishnugupta, and his Arthashastra is the manual of statecraft and economics, separate from the Indica written by the Greek envoy — all correct. The Megasthenes option swaps the author of the Indica into Kautilya's place.

The Panini option misnames him and miscasts the Arthashastra as Ashoka's edicts. The Porus option is plainly false in both name and the nature of the work.

21. (B) The seven limbs are king, ministers, territory and people, fort, treasury, army and allies, and the body-analogy means a single weak limb endangers the whole — the correct list and the correct reason. The geography list replaces the limbs with physical features the chapter does not name. The military list reduces the state to war-tools and wrongly claims force alone holds it. The last option keeps the wrong (social-class) list and merely swaps 'luck' for 'tradition', so it is still incorrect.

22. (B) Listing treasury and army separately reflects their different roles — funding versus defending and enforcing — which holds even though the treasury pays the army, so the separation is purposeful, not an error. The 'really one limb' option misses that distinct functions justify distinct limbs. The paid-in-grain option contradicts the obvious point that the treasury funded the army. The 'never used at the same time' option is plainly false, since a state needs funds and force together.

23. (B) Bindusara links the dynasty as Chandragupta's son and Ashoka's father, Megasthenes was the Greek envoy who wrote the Indica, and Kautilya was the mentor and author of the Arthashastra — the only fully correct matching. The other options shuffle these roles, variously making Bindusara the envoy or the founder, Megasthenes the mentor or Chandragupta's son, and Kautilya Ashoka's father or the envoy — each of which misassigns at least one figure.

24. (C) The Arthashastra is Kautilya's insider manual of how the state should work, and the Indica is Megasthenes' outsider snapshot — the correct pairing of source to strength. Swapping the authorship of the two works is the classic trap and is false. Calling both religious scriptures misdescribes both texts. The poetry-and-edicts option invents genres for each that neither wrote; the edicts were Ashoka's, not Megasthenes'.

25. (A) Bindusara sits between Chandragupta and Ashoka as the founder's son and Ashoka's father — his correct place in the succession. The mentor option confuses him with Kautilya. The envoy option confuses him with Megasthenes. The founder option confuses him with Chandragupta, who actually overthrew the Nandas.

26. (C) The Mauryan answer was provinces under governors and officials, with spies added so the centre could monitor distant affairs and keep watch on its own officials — the correct two-layer description. The abolished-provinces option contradicts the chapter and absurdly makes spies replace the army. The guilds-govern option misattributes provincial rule to guilds and confuses spies with currency. The emperor-tours-every-village option denies the very problem the administration was built to solve.

27. (D) Long-term governance needs a steady income stream, and regular taxation — unlike sporadic plunder or gifts — reliably paid for the army, officials and public works;

that is why it was central. The punishment option misreads tax as a penalty rather than the state's funding base. The enrich-the-guilds option inverts the flow; taxes funded the state, not the guilds. The 'replaced trade and economy' option is self-defeating, since taxes are drawn from a working economy, not a substitute for one.

28. (B) The dhamma-mahamatras existed to promote and oversee Ashoka's Dhamma among the people, a moral-guidance role distinct from revenue or war — exactly what the title implies. The cavalry option turns them into soldiers, confusing administration with the army. The tribute option turns them into tax officials, a different function. The stone-carvers option mistakes the officials who spread Dhamma for the craftsmen who physically engraved the edicts.

29. (D) Administration carried the centre's reach into distant provinces, working alongside the army and treasury — not in place of them — since force and funds remained essential; that corrects the teacher. The poetry option trivialises the officials' real function. The abolished-taxes option contradicts the need for a treasury that officials helped administer. The private-army option fragments the empire's force into rival pieces, the opposite of centralised imperial strength.

30. (A) Ashoka's empire stretched across most of the subcontinent including the northwest toward Afghanistan, while the far south lay outside it — the correct in/out pairing. Excluding the Ganga plains around Pataliputra is impossible, since that heartland held the capital. Excluding the northwest while keeping 'only' the east shrinks the empire far too much. The last option wrongly excludes both the east and the Ganga heartland, again removing core territory the empire certainly held.

31. (B) Ashoka fought Kalinga to enlarge his empire, and the slaughter afterwards moved him toward Dhamma — so the student has the sequence backwards, which is the correct diagnosis. The 'never fought there' option denies the war the chapter centres on. The 'already Buddhist' option invents a fact the chapter does not state and still misses the cause-effect reversal. The 'Buddhism forbade war' option imposes a blanket rule the chapter never asserts and contradicts the war's occurrence.

32. (B) The strongest evidence is Ashoka's own edicts, in which he openly admits his remorse — a first-person record addressed to his subjects, which the chapter highlights. The Megasthenes option is impossible in timing, since the envoy belonged to Chandragupta's reign, before Ashoka. The Kautilya option is likewise anachronistic and concerns statecraft, not Ashoka's grief. The later-temple option offers indirect, second-hand evidence far weaker than Ashoka's own words.

33. (C) Without the remorse that turned him to Dhamma, Ashoka would likely have continued conquering and never produced the Dhamma edicts — the counterfactual the chapter's logic supports. The immediate-collapse option has no basis; remorse or not, the empire did not fall in a single year. The Brahmi-decipherment option confuses a much

later scholarly event with Ashoka's choices. The Chandragupta option is impossible, since his grandfather ruled long before and could not be affected by Ashoka's later decisions.

34. (C) Dhamma was a moral and ethical code — honesty, non-violence, tolerance, dutiful conduct — meant for everyone, not a new faith; that is the chapter's sense. The new-religion option misreads it; Dhamma was ethical guidance, not a replacement creed. The tax option confuses a moral code with revenue. The warfare option is the very opposite of Dhamma's emphasis on non-violence.

35. (A) Carving edicts on rock and pillars across the land gave Ashoka a permanent, public medium present in many distant places — well suited to reaching a vast, scattered population, which is why the chapter calls him a great communicator. The reciting-soldiers option is impractical and not the means the chapter describes. The printing option is anachronistic for the period. The single-temple option fails the very goal of reach, since one central building cannot serve far-flung peoples.

36. (B) Prakrit is a spoken language and Brahmi is the script used to write it — different categories, which is the exact correction. Swapping them, so Brahmi is the language and Prakrit the script, is the classic reversal trap. Calling both scripts (and Greek-only) is doubly wrong. Calling both languages denies that Brahmi is a script at all.

37. (C) Prakrit was common speech, so the people could understand directly, and stone is durable and public, surviving centuries — both choices serve the same goal, which is the correct reasoning. The Sanskrit-not-invented-and-cheapest option offers two false reasons. The secret-tongue option contradicts the whole purpose, since Prakrit was chosen for accessibility, not secrecy. The 'only language that could be carved' and 'paper did not exist anywhere' option states two falsehoods about carving and materials.

38. (B) Brahmi is the ancestor of most modern Indian scripts and Prakrit was the common people's everyday speech — the correct significance of each. The Roman-alphabet option is false, and Prakrit was popular speech, not a refined court tongue. The never-deciphered option is wrong, since Brahmi has been read, and Prakrit was no priestly code. The last option once again reverses language and script, the chapter's recurring trap.

39. (C) The Lion Capital from Ashoka's Sarnath pillar is the national emblem, and the flag's dharmachakra — the wheel of dharma — comes from the same Mauryan art; all three links are correct. The Sanchi-stupa-and-war-chariot option misnames the emblem and misreads the wheel. The Dhauili-elephant-and-trade-routes option does the same with different errors. The dancing-figure-and-sun option misidentifies both the emblem and the wheel's meaning.

40. (D) Architecturally, the capital is the carved top of the column, and Sarnath mattered because the Buddha first taught there — both correct. The capital-city option confuses the architectural term with a city. The treasury option misdefines 'capital' and misplaces the

Kalinga war. The main-edict option misdefines the term and wrongly relocates Chandragupta's defeat of the Nandas to Sarnath.

41. (A) From 232 to 185 BCE is roughly half a century, illustrating how fast an empire can crumble once its strongest ruler is gone — which fits the chapter's theme of fragility. 'Two centuries' miscalculates the gap and draws the wrong lesson of stability. 'Within a single year' overstates the speed and is contradicted by the dates. 'More than three hundred years' grossly overstates the interval and reverses the chapter's point about decline.

42. (A) The paradox is that an empire delivers unity and prosperity while resting on force and tribute, and the fragility follows because a weakening centre lets distant regions break away — the integrated statement the chapter offers. The 'small and large' option misstates the paradox and falsely says empires keep no army. The 'no kings beneath' option contradicts the layered structure and wrongly says empires refuse tribute. The 'spends nothing on an army' option contradicts the chapter's stress on a strong, costly army.

43. (C) Rebellion is likeliest when a weak ruler follows a strong one (the opportunity) and tribute rises (the grievance) — the chapter's two ingredients together. A run of strong emperors removes the opportunity by keeping provinces in check. Lighter tribute in peacetime removes the grievance. Better roads bind the province closer to the centre, working against breakaway rather than for it.

44. (D) Because Ashoka placed edicts across the territory he held, their geographic spread maps roughly how far his empire and influence reached — the correct use. Edicts are moral and administrative proclamations, not records of royal birthdays, so they cannot date Alexander's birth. They do not list daily market prices, so iron prices are out of reach. Nor do they register guilds, so they cannot count them city by city.

45. (D) Ashoka's edicts are his own words and best show his thinking; the Indica is the Greek envoy's outsider account — the correct match of source to strength. The first distractor swaps the authors, falsely making Ashoka write the Indica and a foreigner the edicts. Calling both Ashoka's compositions ignores Megasthenes entirely. Calling both foreign reports ignores that the edicts are Ashoka's own.

46. (C) The Nanda dynasty (5th century BCE) comes first, then Alexander reaches the northwest around 326 BCE, then Chandragupta founds the Maurya empire around 321 BCE, then Ashoka fights Kalinga in his reign (after 268 BCE): (ii), (iv), (i), (iii). Putting Alexander before the Nandas is wrong. Putting Chandragupta before Alexander reverses 326 and 321 BCE. Starting with Chandragupta puts the Mauryas before the Nandas, which is the classic ordering error.

47. (D) Within the dynasty the order is founder Chandragupta, then his son Bindusara, then Ashoka and his Kalinga war, then the empire's end around 185 BCE: (i), (ii), (iii), (iv). Starting with Bindusara puts him before his own father. Placing Kalinga before

Bindusara's reign skips a generation. Putting the empire's end before the Kalinga war is impossible, since Kalinga fell within Ashoka's reign, decades before 185 BCE.

48. (A) Different coins and measures mean the missing support is a common currency and standard measures, and the result is harder trade and uneven taxation that weaken the economy — the correct diagnosis and effect. The army option is wrong, since the empire is said to have a strong army. The communication option is wrong, since it has excellent roads. The art-and-learning option misnames the failing support and draws a consequence (losing officials) that does not follow.

49. (A) Alexander overran Persia before India, and the Maurya empire arose only a few years after he departed, so he could not have touched it — the correct timeline relation. Conquering both is impossible because the Mauryas did not yet exist in his time. Conquering the Mauryas but not Persia reverses what actually happened. The 'both defeated him' option is false; Persia fell to him and the Mauryas postdate him.

50. (D) Tributaries, satraps and officials are three forms of the same answer — projecting the emperor's authority into lands he cannot rule directly — which is why the chapter treats them together. The succession option imports an unrelated function about choosing emperors. The praise-poetry option trivialises all three roles. The 'avoiding tribute' option contradicts the fact that tributaries exist precisely to deliver tribute to the centre.

51. (A) A tributary is a king who keeps his throne and pays tribute, while a satrap is an appointed governor with no realm of his own — the precise contrast. The first distractor swaps the two definitions. The 'larger territory' option invents a size rule that does not exist. The Greek/Indian option assigns ethnicities to the roles that the chapter never specifies.

52. (C) A well-planned, food-secure, prosperous city reflects strong administration (planning) and control over resources (food and prosperity) working together — the two supports illustrated. The 'absence of army and currency' option lists absences, not supports at work. The 'tribute alone, no economy' option contradicts a prosperous city, which implies a working economy. The 'refusal of art and isolation' option again names negatives that a flourishing planned city does not display.

53. (A) A strong army is costly and depends on a thriving economy and steady taxes to pay and sustain it, so force alone cannot hold an empire — the chapter's reasoning. The 'forbidden from provinces' option invents a rule contradicting the army's defensive role. The 'unpaid volunteers' option falsely erases the very cost the chapter emphasises. The 'tributaries defend everything' option wrongly claims the emperor kept no army, which the chapter denies.

54. (B) Since Dhana Nanda fell because lost loyalty gave Chandragupta his opening, retained loyalty would plausibly have let the Nandas endure and resist longer — the

chapter-grounded counterfactual. The 'Ashoka never born' option is an unrelated leap with no basis. The 'Alexander conquers all India' option ignores that his retreat was caused by his own soldiers, not Nanda loyalty. The 'two Arthashastras' option is irrelevant to the Nanda king's conduct.

55. (B) Art and learning supply the shared culture that binds an empire's many peoples — a cohesion neither army nor administration can provide — so neglecting it leaves precisely that gap, which is distinct from what the other supports do. The tribute option falsely ties revenue to arts patronage. The lose-every-soldier option absurdly makes armies depend on poets. The no-fort option ties forts to artists in a way the chapter never claims.

56. (A) Communication networks let commands, troops and news move quickly across distance, so the centre could govern regions the emperor never visited — something an army alone cannot accomplish. The 'replaced the army' option is false; messages do not fight battles. The 'collect tribute, replace officials' option confuses communication with administration's revenue role. The 'abolish currency' option is a non sequitur, since communication does not make a shared currency unnecessary.

57. (C) Orderly self-governing guilds made trade prosper, and that prosperity boosted the king's tax revenue, so leaving them alone served his interest — the conclusion that follows from both facts. The 'run by soldiers' option contradicts the very self-government described. The 'collect tribute' option misreads guilds as tribute-gatherers. The 'tiny workshops with no rules' option flatly contradicts the rule-making, price-fixing guild in the passage.

58. (D) The chapter's deepest lesson is that holding an empire together is harder than founding one, so even the greatest decline — the theme tying the whole chapter together. The 'endures forever' option contradicts the Maurya collapse and the fragility argument. The 'only a strong emperor' option ignores the six interlocking supports. The 'tribute alone' option denies the need for army and administration the chapter insists on.

59. (A) Dropping art and learning removes the binding culture, separate provincial coins fracture unified trade and taxation, and abandoning officials severs the centre's reach into distant lands — three of the chapter's supports failing at once, which is the correct multi-effect answer. The 'grows stronger' option misreads support-cutting as efficiency; the chapter treats each as load-bearing. The 'nothing changes' option denies they are real supports. The 'army disbands instantly' option invents a military collapse none of these three choices directly causes.

60. (D) The incorrect pairing is Megasthenes as the architect of statecraft who wrote the governing manual: that manual is the Arthashastra by Kautilya, while Megasthenes was the Greek envoy who wrote an outsider's account, the Indica. The other three pairings are correct: Chandragupta founded the empire by displacing the Nandas, Kautilya wrote the

science of governance, and Ashoka governed by Dhamma and edicts after the Kalinga war. The question asks for the wrong match, which is the Megasthenes one.